

Navigating the Spreadsheet

Grid & references, navigation, selection, freeze panes and zoom

6

Topics

4

Practices

1,048,576

Rows

16,384

Columns

Understanding the grid

2.1 • Theory

	A	B	C	D	E
1	A1				
2					
3			C3		
4					

A1 is the first cell. C3 is column C, row 3.

Rows

Numbered 1 → 1,048,576

Columns

Labelled A → XFD (16,384 columns)

COLUMN LETTERS

A ... Z → AA, AB ... AZ → BA, BB ... → up to XFD

Cell references

Every cell has a unique address — column letter first, then row number.

Reference	Meaning
A1	Column A, Row 1 — the very first cell (top-left)
C5	Column C, Row 5
B10	Column B, Row 10
Z1	Column Z, Row 1
A1 : D4	Range from A1 to D4 — 4 columns × 4 rows = 16 cells
A : A	The entire column A
3 : 3	The entire row 3

Moving around the spreadsheet

2.3 • Theory

Arrow Keys ← → ↑ ↓

Move one cell in any direction

Tab / **Shift + Tab**

Move right / left one cell

Enter

Move one cell down

Home

Go to column A (same row)

Ctrl + Home

Jump to cell A1

Ctrl + End

Jump to the last used cell

Ctrl + → / **Ctrl + ↓**

Jump to the end of a data block

F5 or **Ctrl + G**

Go To dialog — type any cell address

Ctrl + Page Down / **Up**

Switch to next / previous sheet

Practice 2.3: Move around

Practice · 1 of 4

GOAL

Move with the keyboard and jump to the first and last cells.

- 1 Open Excel. Press **Ctrl+Home**.
- 2 Type **Name**, **Score**, **Grade** in A1, B1, C1 (use Tab).
- 3 Type 3 students in rows 2, 3 and 4.
- 4 Press **Ctrl+End**.
- 5 Press **Ctrl+Home**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Name Box shows A1
- After Ctrl+End: Name Box shows C4
- After Ctrl+Home: back at A1

Selecting cells

2.4 • Theory

One cell

Click it

A range of cells

Click the first cell → hold Shift → click the last. Or click and drag.

Multiple separate cells

Click the first → hold Ctrl → click each additional cell

An entire row

Click the row number on the left (e.g. click 5)

An entire column

Click the column letter at the top (e.g. click C)

Multiple columns / rows

Click and drag across column letters or row numbers

Entire spreadsheet

Click the grey top-left corner box. Or press Ctrl + A

A named range

Click the Name Box → type the range (e.g. A1:D10) → Enter

Practice 2.4: Select cells

Practice · 2 of 4

GOAL

Select a column and a range.

1 Click the column A header.

2 Click **A1**. Hold **Shift**. Click **C4**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Step 1: whole column A highlighted
- Step 2: A1:C4 highlighted

Freeze panes

WITHOUT FREEZE PANES

Omar	72	C+	8
Ayesha	91	A-	2
Zain	64	D	12

Header row is out of sight

WITH FREEZE PANES

Name	Score	Grade	Rank
Ali	88	B+	3
Sara	95	A	1
Omar	72	C+	8

Header stays visible

TO FREEZE

View → Freeze Panes → Freeze Top Row

TO UNFREEZE

View → Freeze Panes → Unfreeze Panes

Practice 2.5: Freeze the header

Practice · 3 of 4

GOAL

Keep Row 1 visible while you scroll.

- 1 Click the **View** tab.
- 2 Freeze Panes → **Freeze Top Row**.
- 3 Press **F5**. Type **A30** → Enter.
- 4 Look at the top of the sheet.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Row 1 stays visible at row 30
- Press Ctrl+Home to go back

Zooming in and out

2.6 • Theory

Slider

Zoom Slider

Drag left (zoom out) or right (zoom in) — bottom-right corner.

Always visible, great for quick adjustments.

Ctrl + Scroll

Ctrl + Scroll Wheel

Hold Ctrl and scroll up (zoom in) or scroll down (zoom out).

Fastest method — hands stay on the keyboard.

View → Zoom

View Tab → Zoom

Set an exact percentage: 75%, 100%, 150%, or any custom value.

Use when you need a precise zoom level.

View → 100%

Reset to 100%

One click to instantly reset back to the standard 100% view.

Quickest way to return to normal view.

Practice 2.6: Zoom and finish

Practice · 4 of 4

GOAL

Zoom in, reset, and show your work.

1 Hold **Ctrl**. Scroll up to zoom in.

2 Click **View** → 100%.

3 Show your screen to the teacher.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Zoom returns to 100%

Unit 2 — Key takeaways

2.1 Excel has 1,048,576 rows and 16,384 columns — labelled A through XFD.

2.2 Cell reference = column letter + row number (e.g. C5, A1:D4, A:A).

2.3 Arrow keys, Tab, Enter, Home, Ctrl+Home / End for fast navigation.

2.4 Shift+click for ranges — Ctrl+click for non-adjacent — Ctrl+A for all.

2.5 Freeze Panes keeps header rows visible while scrolling down.

2.6 Ctrl+Scroll is the fastest zoom — View → 100% resets instantly.